

should ask ourselves regularly: "What is more important, people or things?" As Proverbs 15:16 says, "Better is a little with the fear of the Lord, than great treasure and turmoil with it." The same principle applies to a house and turmoil with it.

Shortly thereafter, Phil put the house up for sale, and in just a few weeks it sold, at a handsome profit. Within a month, Rhonda's symptoms disappeared. They were stress-induced as a result of the financial pressures.

An early warning sign of excessive financial pressure is obsession. If your thoughts continually go back to your financial problems when you're doing something that requires considerable concentration, you probably have excessive debts. If you can't take any time off to relax without nervous tension welling up inside—same symptom. These side effects may appear when you take time out to read God's Word or try to pray.

If a wife experiences these symptoms of financial pressure, she has taken on a responsibility that doesn't belong to her. It belongs to her husband.

Husbands, if you don't want real trouble in your family, decide to assume your proper responsibility and eliminate both the symptoms and the problems God's way.

Problems brought on by financial pressures may also become evident in the sexual relationship. When two people are under tensions manifested through fatigue, anger, and resentments, it is only natural that their most intimate relationship will suffer as well. Even when a couple still has good communication, financial pressures caused by debts can so occupy the wife's mind that temporary frigidity can result. If the financial pressures can be lifted from the wife, even temporarily, her response to her husband will improve markedly.

If a state of tension and pressure is left in force for a long period of time, however, it can devastate the sexual aspect of the marriage.

DANGER SIGN: IRRESPONSIBILITY

A nearly infallible sign of family financial problems is the husband's abdication of his position as the family financial leader.